

AutoFlows

Content Studio

USER MANUAL

One brief in, three channels out: daily social posts,
a blog article, and a marketing email.

Version 1.0.0 | Oct 05, 2026 | PHP 8.1+ • SQLite • Offline-first

Dashboard • TinyLLM Chat • Flows • FlowAgent • Content Library • Gmail + Facebook Publishing • Daily Automation

Self-hosted | No build step | No Composer | MIT License

Start: `php -S 127.0.0.1:8020 -t public public/router.php` → `http://127.0.0.1:8020`

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One brief in, three channels out: daily social posts, a blog article, and a marketing email.

AutoFlows is a self-hosted content studio built with **PHP + SQLite + Bootstrap + Vanilla JS**. No build step, no Composer, no framework. It works **offline-first**: if Ollama / TinyLLM is unreachable, a built-in template engine takes over and the UI tells you with an `offline · template engine` badge.

Table of Contents

- 1. What AutoFlows Does
- 2. Requirements & First Launch
- 3. App Map — Where Everything Lives
- 4. Dashboard — Your Daily Start
- 5. Chat (TinyLLM) — Conversational Creation
- 6. Flows — Repeatable Recipes
- 7. FlowAgent — 6-Step AI Console
- 8. Content Library — Review & Manage
- 9. Editor — Polish Before You Publish
- 10. Publishing — Gmail + Facebook
- 11. Settings — Model + Brand Voice
- 12. Daily Automation (Cron / Task Scheduler)
- 13. Offline Mode & Badges
- 14. Worked Examples End-to-End
- 15. Troubleshooting & FAQ
- 16. Content Lifecycle & Keyboard Tips

1. What AutoFlows Does

Input	Output
A single brief / goal like “why small teams should publish weekly”	3x Social posts (X, LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook, Threads, TikTok) + 1x Blog (title, slug, excerpt, body, tags) + 1x Email (subject, preheader, headline, body, CTA)

Everything is:

- **Traceable**: every run saves `brief → outline → [social] [blog] [email] → review` with a quality `SCORE: n`
- **Editable**: every item lands as `draft` in the Content Library
- **Schedulable**: `draft → approved → scheduled → published (+ archived )`

2. Requirements & First Launch

You need:

- PHP 8.1+ with `pdo_sqlite` (tested on 8.3.30)
- Optional: Ollama running locally for real AI generations

Step-by-step to start:

```
# 1. Open terminal in project folder
cd E:\openaiVideo\autoflows

# 2. Start PHP dev server
php -S 127.0.0.1:8020 -t public public/router.php

# 3. Open in browser
http://127.0.0.1:8020
```

What happens on first boot:

1. `storage/app.db` is created + migrated automatically
2. A starter flow called **Daily founder pack** is seeded
3. Dashboard shows `offline · template engine` until Ollama connects

For Apache (production):

1. Point DocumentRoot at `public/`
2. Enable `mod_rewrite` + `AllowOverride All`
3. `public/.htaccess` rewrites everything through `index.php`

For Ollama (optional but recommended):

```
ollama serve
ollama pull tinyllama
# or stronger writing:
ollama pull qwen2.5:1.5b
```

Then go to `Settings → TinyLLM connection → Test connection` .

3. App Map — Where Everything Lives

URL (<code>?r=</code>)	Screen	Use it to...
<code>/</code> or <code>?r=home</code>	Dashboard	See stats, due-today queue, Quick Generate
<code>?r=chat</code>	TinyLLM Chat	Talk + use <code>/social</code> <code>/blog</code> <code>/email</code> <code>/daily</code> commands
<code>?r=flows</code>	Flows	List daily / weekly / manual recipes
<code>?r=flow&id=1</code>	Flow Editor	Create / edit a recipe + Save & Run
<code>?r=content</code>	Content Library	Filter, bulk approve, export
<code>?r=item&id=12</code>	Editor	Edit with live preview, regenerate, publish

URL ()	Screen	Use it to...
?r=agent	FlowAgent Console	Run 6-step agent, watch live trace, replay runs
?r=settings	Settings	Model, brand voice, OAuth, database info
?r=login	Login	Continue with Google / Facebook or Dev login

Top nav always shows: LLM status badge (`online` green / `offline` yellow), user avatar, Channels status.

4. Dashboard — Your Daily Start

Open `http://127.0.0.1:8020/`

You see:

- **6 stat cards:** Today, Queue, Drafts, Published, Flows, Items
- **Quick Generate** (left): one brief, one click
- **Schedule / Today's Queue** (right): what's due
- **Activity feed:** recent runs + publishes

Example: Quick Generate in 30 seconds

1. Stay on Dashboard
2. Click tab: `Social posts` | `Blog post` | `Marketing email`
3. In **Brief** type:
why small teams should publish weekly instead of chasing virality
4. Set **Tone:** `Warm` , **Variants:** `3`
5. Click **Generate**
6. Watch progress bar → “Done — 3 drafts → View in Content”
7. Click link → Content Library shows 3 new `draft` items

Tip: Quick Generate always creates `draft` s. Nothing auto-publishes.

5. Chat (TinyLLM) — Conversational Creation

Go to `Chat` in nav. Layout:

- **Left rail:** Threads (+ to create new, click to switch, pin/active highlight)
- **Center:** Streaming thread with Copy / Trace / Delete per message
- **Right / Below:** Model controls (temperature, tokens, system)

5.1 Basic chat

1. Click + for New chat
2. Type in box: `Give me 5 hooks for a post about content loops`

3. Press **Enter** (Shift+Enter for newline)
4. Watch streaming → final bubble replaces deltas when `done` arrives

Buttons in header:

- `Export` (Markdown download), `Eraser` (clear thread), `Trash` (delete thread)

5.2 Slash commands — the real power

Type these in chat input and hit Enter:

Command	What to type	What you get
<code>/social</code>	<code>/social why small teams should publish weekly</code>	3 platform-aware variants (e.g. X 280 chars, LinkedIn 3000)
<code>/blog</code>	<code>/blog building a repeatable content loop</code>	title + slug + excerpt + 400-600w article + tags
<code>/email</code>	<code>/email re-engaging dormant trial users</code>	subject + preheader + headline + body + CTA
<code>/daily</code>	<code>/daily content marketing without a big team</code>	all three channels in one run
<code>/status</code>	<code>/status</code>	model reachability + latency ms
<code>/help</code>	<code>/help</code>	command list

Example session:

```
You: /daily launch checklist for solo founders
AutoFlows: [streams brief → outline → social → blog → email → review SCORE: 82]
          Created 5 items: #12 #13 #14 #15 #16 [View library] [Trace #45]
```

Every generated item links back to **Trace** (`?r=agent&run=45`) for full replay.

5.3 Model controls

- **Temperature** 0-2 (default 0.75): lower = safer, higher = creative
- **Max tokens** 64-4096 (default 768)
- **System prompt**: defaults from Settings, editable per thread

6. Flows — Repeatable Recipes

Go to `Flows` . Each flow = reusable prompt + schedule.

Fields:

- **Name*** e.g. `Weekly founder pack`
- **Channel***: Social | Blog | Email | Daily pack (all three)
- **Standing brief***: stable theme prepended to every run
- **Variants**: 1-10 (how many social variants per run)
- **Tone**: warm / direct / playful / authoritative / friendly / contrarian
- **Audience**: e.g. `founders, small marketing teams`

- **Platforms** (social only): checkboxes X, LinkedIn, Instagram, Facebook, Threads, TikTok with char limits shown
- **Schedule**: Every day / Once a week / Manual only
- **Weekday** (if weekly): Monday-Sunday
- **Run at**: HH:MM e.g. 09:00
- **Active** toggle

Example: Create a Daily Pack (step-by-step)

1. Flows → New flow (?r=flow or Flows #new)
2. **Name**: Daily founder pack
3. **Channel**: Daily pack (all three)
4. **Standing brief**:

practical content-marketing lessons for small teams, no hype, short sentences

5. **Variants**: 3 , **Tone**: warm , **Audience**: founders
6. **Schedule**: Every day , **Run at**: 09:00 , **Active**: ON
7. Watch **Live plan preview** on right update: brief → outline → [social][blog][email] → review
8. Click **Save** → then **Save & Run** to test now
9. You're redirected to Agent trace; outputs appear in Content as drafts

Run / Pause / Delete

- **Run now** button on row (manual trigger, logs trigger_by=manual)
- **Toggle** switch = active/inactive (inactive never runs in cron)
- **Delete** asks confirm, keeps content (flow_id set NULL)

7. FlowAgent — 6-Step AI Console

Go to Run FlowAgent / ?r=agent . This is the full pipeline with live streaming.

Plan always:

brief → outline → [social] [blog] [email] → review (SCORE: n)

Events over SSE: run_start → step → delta* → step_done → done

Example: Full Agent Run

1. Open Agent
2. **Goal**:

why small teams should publish weekly instead of chasing virality

3. **Channels**: check all three (uncheck Email if you only want Social+Blog)
4. **Social platforms**: check X / Twitter , LinkedIn , Facebook (first 3 default)

5. **Tone:** Brand default (or override), **Social variants:** 3
6. **Audience override:** leave blank (uses brand voice) or type indie hackers
7. Click **Run agent**
8. Watch **Plan** list light up: brief... ✓ → outline... ✓ → social streaming...
9. **Trace** panel shows live markdown per step
10. On done : banner Run #46 done · 5 outputs · SCORE 84 (threshold 70)
11. **Outputs** cards appear below with Edit / Approve buttons
12. **Run history** (right/bottom): click any past run → replay full trace (?r=agent&run=46)

If score < 70, review step flags it yellow — edit manually in Content.

8. Content Library — Review & Manage

Go to **Content** . You see filters + grid/table of items.

Filters:

- **Channel:** All / Social / Blog / Email
- **Status:** draft / approved / scheduled / published / archived
- **Search:** title/body/hashtags
- **Sort:** Newest / Score / Chars

Bulk actions:

1. Tick checkboxes (or Select all)
2. Choose: Approve , Schedule , Publish , Archive , Delete
3. Click Apply → toast confirms

Export:

- Export CSV / Export JSON → saved to storage/exports/ + download link

Example workflow:

1. Filter Status=draft
2. Open newest pack items
3. Tick 3 social → Approve
4. Set Publish at for tomorrow 09:00 → Schedule
5. Tomorrow cron publishes or you click Publish now

9. Editor — Polish Before You Publish

Open any item (?r=item&id=12). Split view: **Form left, Live preview right.**

For Social:

- **Body** (Markdown) + char counter 182 / 280 (red if over)
- **Hashtags** field e.g. #contentmarketing #smallteams

- **Platform** badge shows limit: X 280, Threads 500, LinkedIn 3000, etc.

For Blog:

- **Title, Slug** (auto from title, editable: `repeatable-content-loop`), **Excerpt** 0 / 160 , **Body** Markdown, **Tags**

For Email:

- **Subject line** 0 / 45 counter, **Preheader**, **CTA button**, **In-email headline**, **Body** (plain text → rendered HTML preview)

Common right-side:

- **Status** dropdown, **Publish at** datetime-local, **Score** badge
- **Trace** button (if from run), **Regenerate** button
- **Publish box**: **To** (for Gmail) + **Publish** button + last `publish_result` JSON
- **Save** (Ctrl+S), **Preview** auto-updates on typing

Example: Edit + Approve + Schedule

1. Open draft #12 (X post, 312/280 red)
2. Trim body to 240 chars → counter turns dark
3. Add hashtags: `#marketing #founders`
4. Change **Status** to `approved` , set **Publish at** to `2026-10-06 09:00`
5. Click **Save** → toast `Saved`
6. Click **Schedule** → moves to Queue on Dashboard
7. Optional: click **Regenerate** → choose `shorter` / `punchier` → new variant replaces body (old kept in history)

10. Publishing — Gmail + Facebook

Without setup, publishing is **simulated** (recorded in `content.meta.publish_result = {ok, simulated:true, ...}`).

10.1 One-click dev (try offline)

1. Go to `?r=login`
2. Click **Gmail dev** or **FB dev**
3. You're logged in as `dev@example.com` with simulated channel
4. Now Publish buttons work end-to-end, marked `simulated`

10.2 Real Gmail send

1. **Settings** → **Channels** → copy redirect URI:

```
http://127.0.0.1:8020/index.php?r=auth/google/callback
```

2. Google Cloud Console → New project → APIs & Services → Credentials → Create OAuth Client ID (Web app) → paste URI
3. Enable **Gmail API**, add test user, scopes: `openid email profile + gmail.send`
4. Paste **Client ID + Secret** into Settings → Save
5. Click **Connect Gmail** → approve → token stored obfuscated
6. To publish email: open email item → enter recipient To: `founder@example.com` → **Publish via Gmail** → real `message_id` saved

10.3 Real Facebook Page post

1. developers.facebook.com → Create App (Business) → Add **Facebook Login** → Valid OAuth Redirect:

```
http://127.0.0.1:8020/index.php?r=auth/facebook/callback
```

2. Scopes: `public_profile email pages_manage_posts pages_read_engagement`
3. Make login account admin of Page → AutoFlows picks first manageable Page via `/me/accounts`
4. Paste **App ID + Secret** → Save → **Connect Facebook**
5. To publish social: open social item (platform=facebook or blank) → **Post to Facebook** → real `post_id` saved
6. Other platforms (X, LinkedIn...): recorded as simulated cross-post copy

Every result visible on editor card + `task_logs ( publish.* )`.

11. Settings — Model + Brand Voice

Go to `?r=settings` . Everything saves to `settings` table (wins over `app/config.php`).

Left: TinyLLM connection

- Provider: `ollama` or `Template engine` – force offline
- Endpoint: `http://127.0.0.1:11434` (hint: `ollama serve`)
- Model dropdown: `tinylama` , `gemma3:1b` , `qwen2.5:1.5b` (auto-lists from Ollama `/api/tags`)
- Temperature slider, Max tokens slider, System prompt textarea
- **Test connection** → shows `reachable · 42 ms` or `unreachable` – ...
- Database card: file name + row counts per table

Right: Brand voice (injected into EVERY prompt)

- Name: `Acme Studio` , Voice: `friendly, practical...` , Audience, Products, Links, CTA: `Start your free week` , Emoji ON/OFF, Hashtags ON/OFF

Example: Revoice whole app

1. Change **Voice** to: `direct, contrarian, no fluff, 8-word sentences max`
2. Change **CTA** to: `Get the checklist`
3. Click **Save settings** → toast + `config_refresh()`
4. Re-run any flow → all 3 channels use new voice

Channels section (OAuth keys, seal key, default Gmail To) + **Reset all** + **Save**.

12. Daily Automation (Cron / Task Scheduler)

A flow runs when: `active=1 AND schedule != manual AND now >= run_at AND not already run today` .

```
php tools/run_daily.php          # run everything due
php tools/run_daily.php --dry     # show what would run
php tools/run_daily.php --force   # ignore last_run_at, re-run today
php tools/run_daily.php --publish # also move scheduled → published
```

Windows (Task Scheduler, daily 09:00):

```
schtasks /create /tn AutoFlows /tr "php E:\openaiVideo\autoflows\tools\run_daily.php" /sc
```

Linux cron:

```
0 9 * * * php /path/to/autoflows/tools/run_daily.php --publish
```

13. Offline Mode & Badges

Badge	Meaning	What to do
tinylama online green	Ollama reachable	Real generations, streaming tokens
offline · template engine yellow	Ollama down or provider=local	Deterministic templates, fully usable, <code>localReply()</code> / <code>localDraft()</code> / <code>localStep()</code>
score 84 green / yellow	Review quality gate (threshold 70)	<70 = edit manually
simulated in publish_result	No real token	Connect OAuth or keep testing

Never a silent downgrade — UI always shows path.

14. Worked Examples End-to-End

Example A: Solo founder, 10-min daily loop

1. Dashboard → Quick Generate → Channel `Social` → Brief `3 lessons from shipping daily for 30 days` → Generate
2. Content → open #1 → trim for X (280), approve → Schedule tomorrow 09:00
3. Chat → `/blog 3 lessons from shipping daily for 30 days` → open blog draft → fix title, excerpt 150 chars → Approve
4. Chat → `/email re-engaging trial users who went quiet` → open email → set Subject `We saved your progress (28/45)` → Publish via Gmail dev
5. Dashboard Queue shows 2 scheduled, Activity shows publish log

Example B: Weekly pack via FlowAgent

Goal: content marketing without a big team

- 1. Agent → check all channels, platforms X+LinkedIn+Facebook, Tone Warm, Variants 3 → Run
- 2. Trace: brief (goal clarified) → outline (3 angles) → social (3 posts) → blog (650w) → email → review SCORE: 81
- 3. Outputs → Bulk Approve in Content → set Publish at staggered Mon/Wed/Fri → Schedule
- 4. Enable cron --publish → auto-publishes when due

Example C: Connect + Real publish

- 1. Settings → Channels → paste Google Client ID/Secret → Save → Connect Gmail
- 2. Content → Email item → To: customer@example.com → Publish → message_id: 18d... green
- 3. Settings → paste Facebook App ID/Secret → Connect Facebook (as Page admin)
- 4. Content → Social/Facebook item → Post → post_id: 123_456 green

15. Troubleshooting & FAQ

	Fix	
e always	ollama serve running? Endpoint correct? Settings → Test connection . Or intentionally use template engine.	
0	Check storage/logs/ , PHP version 8.1+, pdo_sqlite enabled: `php -m \	findstr sqlite`
	Stop duplicate php -S , delete -journal , ensure one writer	
s in cron	Check Active ON, schedule != manual, run_at past, not already run today; try --dry then --force	
mulated	No OAuth token → Connect Gmail/FB or use dev login; this is expected offline	
ission error	App in Dev Mode only works for admins/testers; add tester or submit pages_manage_posts for review	
_mismatch	Redirect URI must match exactly incl. http:// vs https:// + path ?r=auth/google/callback	
red	Trim body or split into thread; limit includes hashtags	
20	`netstat -ano \	findstr :8020 → kill PID or use :8021`
plying	Click Save (calls config_refresh()); file defaults only fallback	

Smoke test before reporting bug:

```
php tools/smoke_test.php          # lint + unit + live HTTP
php tools/smoke_test.php --fast # skip HTTP
netstat -ano | findstr :8021      # should print nothing (no leak)
```

16. Content Lifecycle & Keyboard Tips

draft → approved → scheduled → published
■ archived (any stage)

- `Ctrl+S` in Editor = Save
- `Enter` in Chat = Send, `Shift+Enter` = newline
- Click chip-prompt (`/social...`) to autofill input
- CSRF auto via `X-CSRF-Token` header (`AF.api()`), SSE via `fetch()` + `AF.stream()` (EventSource can't POST)
- All times local; `publish_at` uses `datetime-local`
- Exports in `storage/exports/` , DB in `storage/app.db` — back up that file

Need help? Open `README.md` (dev overview), `OAUTH_SETUP.md` (Gmail/FB deep dive), `schema.sql` (tables). Happy shipping!